- `eager_load!` If `config.eager_load` is true, runs the `config.before_eager_load` hooks and then calls `eager_load!` which will load all `config.eager_load_namespaces`.
- `finisher_hook` Provides a hook for after the initialization of process of the application is complete, as well as running all the `config.after_initialize` blocks for the application, railties and engines.
- `set_routes_reloader` Configures Action Dispatch to reload the routes file using `ActionDispatch::Callbacks.to_prepare`.
- `disable_dependency_loading` Disables the automatic dependency loading if the `config.eager_load` is set to true.

7 Database pooling

Active Record database connections are managed by `ActiveRecord::ConnectionAdapters::ConnectionPool` which ensures that a connection pool synchronizes the amount of thread access to a limited number of database connections. This limit defaults to 5 and can be configured in `database.yml`.

```
development:
  adapter: sqlite3
  database: db/development.sqlite3
  pool: 5
  timeout: 5000
```

Since the connection pooling is handled inside of Active Record by default, all application servers (Thin, mongrel, Unicorn etc.) should behave the same. Initially, the database connection pool is empty and it will create additional connections as the demand for them increases, until it reaches the connection pool limit.

Any one request will check out a connection the first time it requires access to the database, after which it will check the connection back in, at the end of the request, meaning that the additional connection slot will be available again for the next request in the queue.

If you try to use more connections than are available, Active Record will block and wait for a connection from the pool. When it cannot get connection, a timeout error similar to given below will be thrown.

```
ActiveRecord::ConnectionTimeoutError - could not obtain a database
connection within 5 seconds. The max pool size is currently 5; consider
increasing it:
```

If you get the above error, you might want to increase the size of connection pool by incrementing the`pool` option in `database.yml`

If you are running in a multi-threaded environment, there could be a chance that several threads may be accessing multiple connections simultaneously. So depending on your current request load, you could very well have multiple threads contending for a limited amount of connections.

8 Custom configuration

You can configure your own code through the Rails configuration object with custom configuration. It works like this:

```
config.x.payment_processing.schedule = :daily
config.x.payment_processing.retries  = 3
config.x.super_debugger = true
```

These configuration points are then available through the configuration object:

```
Rails.configuration.x.payment_processing.schedule # => :daily
```